

Internal Workings of Dubbo Christian School (DCS) and Its Associated Campuses

Introduction: Dubbo Christian School (DCS) is part of a network of Christian educational institutions in the Dubbo region, encompassing a K–12 school in Dubbo, a three-room preschool on the Dubbo campus, and a smaller K–6 campus in Wellington. All together, these serve nearly 700 students from Kindergarten to Year 12 at Dubbo (plus ~120 preschoolers) and about 70+ primary students at Wellington. As an incoming ICT/Library and admin staff member (with responsibilities at the Dubbo campus and Preschool), it's helpful to understand **how this network is governed, who the key people are, and what systems and processes shape daily operations**. Below is a comprehensive overview of DCS's internal workings – from governance and leadership to technology systems and culture – gleaned from public information.

How Are the School and Preschool Governed and Organized?

Berakah Christian Education Ltd (BCE): DCS is not a standalone entity but operates under an overarching company, Berakah Christian Education Ltd. “Berakah” means “*blessing*” in Hebrew, reflecting the organization’s aim to be a blessing through Christian education. BCE is essentially a **parent-controlled association** that governs DCS, Wellington Christian School (WCS), and Dubbo Christian Preschool (DCP) under one mission and budget. All three campuses share the same vision and values, and their **strategic and financial governance is unified**. For example, major decisions and budgets are made at the BCE level, allowing resources to be shared across Dubbo, Wellington, and the Preschool as needed.

Board and Association: The BCE Board of Directors is elected from among the association’s members (who are Christian parents and supporters of the school). This **Board sets the vision, policy, and direction** for all campuses. Importantly, because DCS follows a **Christian parent-controlled model**, teachers or staff cannot be voting members of the Association – governance is kept in parents’ hands to avoid conflicts of interest. Parents (and other Christians) can apply to become association members by affirming the school’s Statement of Faith and Educational Creed, and once approved, they get voting rights at the Annual General Meeting. In practice, this means **major decisions involve parent input**: the Board is accountable to the broader school community of Christian parents. The Board’s objective per the constitution is “*to operate the schools providing Christ-centred, Bible-based education*” in line with the foundational beliefs. The Board meets regularly and also presents an **Annual Report** covering all campuses to both government authorities and the association membership. (For example, BCE submits combined audited financials and Annual Information Statements for DCS/WCS/DCP as one entity each year.)

Key governance features:

- **Volunteer Board Composition:** Current Board members include a mix of parents from various campuses. For instance, the Board Chair (as of 2024) is Mr. **Shane Duke**, a DCS parent who has served on the Board ~7 years. Other directors include professionals like **Jeff Neill** (a local business manager and long-time parent, former Board Chair), **Clifford Stephens** (Treasurer, accounting background), **Jill Vippond**, **Rebecca Roennfeldt**, and **James Corfield**, among others. Each brings a different skill set (finance, marketing, education, etc.) to governance. This breadth helps ensure the schools are well-run and true to their mission.
- **Association Meetings:** At the Annual General Meeting (AGM), members vote on board elections (with roughly one-third of directors up for re-election each year) and can raise questions. The parent association model means **transparency and accountability** – the Board shares strategic plans, financial results, and policy updates with the community.
- **Policies and Faith Basis:** The Association actively upholds foundational documents like the Statement of Faith and Educational Creed. All policies – from discipline to curriculum – are expected to align with a biblical worldview. For example, the Educational Charter emphasizes that parents delegate the daily teaching to the school under God’s guidance, so the **school sees itself as partnering with families in a God-given mission**. This perspective permeates decision-making at every level.

In summary, **the governance structure is highly mission-driven and community-based:** a parent-led board ensuring the school (across all campuses) stays **Christ-centered, accountable, and sustainable**. As staff, you won’t be involved in governance directly, but it’s good to know that decisions come from a partnership of dedicated Christian parents and professionals rather than a distant bureaucracy.

What Is the Leadership and Management Structure?

While the Board governs at a high level, the **day-to-day leadership** of DCS and its sister campuses is handled by the school’s executive staff and campus leaders. Here’s how it’s structured:

- **Executive Principal (BCE):** Dubbo Christian School’s Principal also serves as the *Executive Principal* of all Berakah campuses. **Mr. Paul Arundell** is the current Principal of DCS and Executive Principal overseeing WCS and the Preschool as of 2025. He succeeded the long-serving former principal, Mr. Warren Melville, around 2020–2021. In practice, this means Mr. Arundell not only leads the Dubbo campus but also mentors the Wellington Head of Campus and works closely with the Preschool Director, ensuring consistency of vision and standards across the board. *Update:* Mr. Arundell is approaching retirement – after a 41-year career in Christian education, he will finish his tenure at the end of 2025, and a **new Principal is set to commence in January 2026**. (The school advertised for a 2026 Principal, signaling a leadership transition.) Internally, the Deputy Principal has been preparing to “**fill those big shoes**” and maintain continuity in culture and academics. You can expect a leadership handover as the new Principal (to be announced if not already) steps in

for the 2026 school year.

- **Senior Leadership Team (SLT) at DCS:** Dubbo Christian School has a Senior Leadership Team under the Principal that manages various domains:
 - **Deputy Principal(s):** DCS historically has had Deputy Principals or Heads for different sub-schools (e.g. Head of Primary, Head of Secondary). Greg Collins, for instance, has served as a Deputy Principal in recent years (with a background from Sydney). Deputies handle operational matters, student discipline, and academics in their areas, and often one of them acts in the Principal's stead if needed.
 - **Director of Teaching and Learning:** This role focuses on curriculum and teacher development. (*E.g., Mr. Tim Knight has been noted as a Director of Teaching & Learning.*) They ensure that the “**Transformation by Design**” framework (a Christian curriculum design model) is implemented across subjects, and that **academic standards remain high** while integrating biblical perspectives.
 - **Business Manager:** The Business Manager oversees finance, facilities, and non-teaching administration. **Mr. Scott Morris** is the current Business Manager. He handles budgets, capital projects, compliance reporting, and often HR/administrative operations. (For instance, Mr. Morris' office would manage staff contracts, maintenance schedules, and also things like fee assistance programs.) Expect to interact with the Business Manager's office for any resource or support needs in ICT and the library – he is effectively the COO of the school.
 - **ICT Manager:** DCS has a dedicated **ICT Manager** who leads the technology team and infrastructure across all campuses. The ICT Manager is responsible for strategic IT planning and day-to-day tech operations, reporting up to the Business Manager/Principal. (The ICT Manager's name may not be publicly advertised; previously individuals like *Paul Semple* or *Shane Negen* have been associated with the role.) As an ICT/Library staff, you will likely report to or work closely with the ICT Manager for technical tasks.
 - **Other Key Roles:** The school also employs coordinators for areas like **Learning Support, Pastoral Care/Chaplaincy**, and Heads of Departments for subjects. There is a **School Chaplain** or Christian Studies coordinator who oversees spiritual development programs. Additionally, **administrative staff** such as the Registrar/Enrolments Officer and Receptionist fall under the admin umbrella.
- **Wellington Christian School Leadership:** WCS (the K–6 campus in Wellington, ~50 km from Dubbo) has a *Head of Campus (Principal)* who manages day-to-day operations there. This person reports to the Executive Principal and ensures WCS runs smoothly. In 2025, a new principal, **Mr. Peter Reuben**, was welcomed to lead Wellington CS (noted as a “new Principal” in a message from January 2025) – indicating fresh leadership at WCS as well. The WCS principal and DCS principal work in tandem to keep curriculum and ethos aligned, with Mr. Arundell providing executive oversight. Because WCS is much smaller (around 70–80 students), the Head of Campus often wears multiple hats – principal, teacher mentor, and sometimes class teaching duties – but gets support from DCS (for example, WCS

can draw on DCS's specialist teachers or admin systems when needed).

- **Dubbo Christian Preschool Leadership:** The Preschool (DCP) has its own **Director**, who is in charge of early childhood operations. **Mrs. Michelle Broadley** is the Preschool Director. She handles the preschool's staff, curriculum (play-based learning program), and compliance with early childhood regulations. Notably, she is the **Nominated Supervisor** for the service (with Mr. Arundell listed as a secondary Nominated Supervisor for oversight). As a new admin working with the preschool, Mrs. Broadley will likely be your immediate supervisor for preschool-related duties. Under her, the preschool has a small team of early childhood educators (some Diploma or Certificate III qualified assistants and at least one university-qualified Early Childhood Teacher – often the Director herself holds a teaching degree). The preschool team coordinates with the main school for things like facilities and events (since the preschool is on the school campus).

Overall, **each campus has an on-site leader for day-to-day decisions**, but they function as one family. The DCS Principal (Executive Principal) guides the whole group's direction, and there's a lot of collaboration – e.g., joint leadership meetings of DCS/WCS/Preschool heads to ensure unity. For you, this means even though you'll be based in Dubbo, you might occasionally liaise with Wellington staff or support their IT needs (the ICT systems are centralized). Also, expect **clear lines of reporting**: you'll report to a manager (ICT Manager for technical tasks and possibly the Preschool Director for daily preschool admin tasks) who in turn report up to the Principal or Business Manager.

Fun fact: DCS's long-term leadership has been very stable. The founding principal started in 1983 and set the culture; by the 2000s, Principal Warren Melville led for ~12 years of significant growth. Paul Arundell continued that legacy with a future-focused approach (he spearheaded a major masterplan for campus development). This stability means the school likely has **well-established procedures** and a strong sense of identity, which new leaders inherit and build upon.

What Systems and Processes Will You Work With (ICT, Library, Admin)?

One of the most practical things to know is the **IT and administrative systems** in use, since you'll be working in ICT support and library management. DCS is quite modern and **well-resourced technologically** (as indicated by job listings and public info). Here's an overview of key systems and processes:

- **Network and Infrastructure:** The school operates a robust IT infrastructure across the campus. There is a central **server room and network** that services the school's needs, managed by the ICT team. The network includes campus-wide Wi-Fi (covering classrooms, Library, offices, and even the Preschool area) and wired connections for computer labs and offices. Internet access is filtered to ensure a child-safe online environment (as expected in a school setting). The Systems Administrator role description highlights maintaining **ICT server infrastructure and**

related services so staff and students can work without interruption. Expect standard Windows servers (Active Directory, file shares, etc.) and maybe some cloud-hosted services.

- **Microsoft 365 Ecosystem:** DCS leverages Microsoft 365 extensively. Staff and secondary students have Microsoft 365 accounts, enabling use of **Exchange email, SharePoint/OneDrive, Teams, and other Office apps**. Email addresses use the @dubbocs.edu.au domain – e.g., you may get an account like *firstname.lastname@dubbocs.edu.au*. The inclusion of Teams suggests the school may use it for internal communication and possibly for classes (especially useful if remote learning is needed or for cross-campus collaboration). One public job listing explicitly required experience with “Microsoft M365 Services: Exchange, SharePoint, Teams, etc.” – so you’ll be stepping into an environment where proficiency in Outlook, OneNote/Teams, and SharePoint will be important. (Many teachers likely use OneNote Class Notebooks or Teams to share resources with students.)
- **Device Management – Windows & iPads:** DCS supports a mix of devices. On the Windows side, they use enterprise tools like **Microsoft SCCM (System Center Configuration Manager)** and **MDT** for deploying and managing PCs. This indicates a well-managed fleet of desktop computers (such as those in labs or staff laptops) with standardized images and update processes. On the Apple side, the school heavily uses **iPads** – they have a mobile device management system, **Jamf School**, to manage iPads in the classroom. Likely, primary classes and perhaps the preschool use school-owned iPads for educational apps, and Jamf ensures they are configured with appropriate apps and restrictions. (You might help with deploying apps or troubleshooting iPad issues for teachers and kids – a good thing to brush up on if you haven’t used Jamf MDM before.) The presence of both SCCM and Jamf suggests **cross-platform support**, and the ICT team collaborates on keeping everything running. There’s also mention of **audio-visual systems**, so the ICT team probably maintains classroom interactive boards, projectors, sound systems (for the Hall, etc.), and maybe the security CCTV.
- **Data Backup and Security:** The school takes data integrity seriously. They use **Veeam** for backups – a reliable backup solution for virtual servers and data. Part of the Systems Admin duties is to “manage the school’s backup solution so that backups can be relied upon”. So, behind the scenes, nightly backups of servers (file servers, admin systems, etc.) are running. There is likely a business continuity plan for critical systems. As an ICT staff, you might not directly handle backups at first, but it’s good to know there’s a safety net. Cybersecurity measures (firewalls, antivirus, content filters) are in place to protect the school community, though specific products aren’t named publicly. Given the environment, **expect strong filtering and user access controls** – e.g., student accounts will have limited permissions, and staff follow acceptable use policies.
- **Student Information System (SIS):** DCS uses a digital student management and parent communication system. From public clues, **Sentral** is used as the parent/student portal. Sentral is a popular Australian school platform – through it, attendance is marked, student data and reports are managed, and parents can view

updates. The text mentions “services like the Sentral parent portal” being managed by IT, confirming its use. As an admin, you may assist with tasks in Sentral (e.g., helping a teacher who has an issue with marking rolls, or resetting a parent portal password). **Schoolbox** is another platform the school uses – in fact, DCS has an integrated “**OurDCS**” portal powered by **Schoolbox** with a companion mobile app. Schoolbox works alongside Sentral: it likely serves as an internal Learning Management System and community portal for news, resources, and e-learning content. The *Dubbo Christian School app* (available on iOS/Android) was “developed in partnership with Digistorm and Schoolbox”, giving parents and students access to announcements, calendars, and possibly class materials on their phones. This reflects a **digitally connected community** – many routine communications (newsletters, event notices, permission forms) are probably handled through the app or online portal, reducing paper. For you, familiarity with how to post a news item or help a parent navigate the app could be handy. It’s worth noting that these systems (Sentral, Schoolbox) tie into **attendance, academic reports, and parent-teacher communications**, which are core school processes.

- **Library Management:** The DCS Library (often called a **Resource Centre**) serves the whole school K–12, and possibly provides some resources to the preschool as well. The **Library runs its own IT systems** that you might manage or support. Typically, Australian school libraries use software like Softlink **Oliver** or Infiniti for cataloguing and lending. While the specific system isn’t named publicly, the job description for Teacher Librarian indicates responsibility to “manage the library’s IT systems and related technology”. Expect a **digital catalog**, barcode scanners, and possibly student ID cards for borrowing. The library likely has PCs for student use and maybe tablets. As ICT/Library support, you might assist in maintaining the catalog database, troubleshooting library computers, or helping students access online research resources. The library team often coordinates with IT on things like ensuring the library system is backed up (likely on the server) and accessible via the web. Also, DCS runs a **Library Monitors program** and a **Library Committee** (involving student volunteers) – an internal process where students help in the library. Part of your role could be to guide these student volunteers in using the systems (for example, how to check in/out books in the software, or how to reshelve properly). The Librarian is expected to keep “*efficient procedures and systems for delivery of services*” including flexible scheduling for classes to use the library. So, there’s a culture of making the library a vibrant hub – you’ll be joining that effort, possibly by organizing ICT aspects of library events (like setting up a projector for a Book Week presentation, etc.).
- **Administrative Processes:** In your admin support capacity (especially for the Preschool), you’ll encounter various **office systems**:
 - **Email and Calendar:** As mentioned, Outlook 365 will be a primary tool for internal communication. Meetings (even across campuses) are likely scheduled via shared calendars. For example, weekly staff meetings, or ICT team check-ins, will appear on your Outlook calendar.
 - **File Management:** The school likely uses SharePoint/OneDrive for collaborative document storage (since they have M365). However, some

offices might still use a shared network drive on the server. The Business Manager's office might provide templates for forms, policies, etc., via the staff intranet (possibly on Schoolbox or SharePoint). Part of "internal workings" is knowing where to find what – e.g., HR forms, student medical info (likely in Sentral or a secure drive), maintenance request forms (maybe an online form or helpdesk).

- **Finance/Admin Systems:** The accounts and HR side may use tools like MYOB or TASS or other school admin software, but that's mostly handled by the Business Manager's team. For the Preschool specifically, there may be an additional system for **childcare compliance** – e.g., some preschools use software like **Xplor or QikKids** for enrolments, attendance, and government childcare subsidy reporting. Given DCP is integrated with the school, they might manage preschool enrolments through the main school database, but still must record daily attendance for licensing. You might help by printing sign-in sheets or maintaining digital sign-in kiosks if they have them. The **Preschool's operating hours and program** (8:30am sign-in to 3:30-4:00pm pick-up) are outlined in the Preschool Prospectus, and they operate 40 weeks/year aligned roughly with school terms. The admin process for preschool includes ensuring all children's attendance is marked and ratios (staff:children) are maintained. The **Nominated Supervisors (Michelle Broadley and Paul Arundell)** are listed on documentation – meaning any incident or compliance issue is signed off by them. If you handle some preschool admin, expect to help with **enrolment paperwork, fee invoicing (in coordination with accounts), immunization record tracking**, etc., under the Director's guidance.
- **Centralized Services:** Many administrative services are centralized for efficiency. HR, Payroll, and Finance are all handled centrally by BCE for all campuses. For example, the **payroll system** will be the same for preschool and school staff. If you have any admin responsibility like timesheets or ordering supplies, you'll use the same process as the rest of DCS. The centralization also means if WCS needs IT help or library support, they may call on you or your team – in fact, the ICT Systems Admin's job description mentions supporting "the other schools we support" so that infrastructure remains functional for all. There might be a **ticketing system** for IT support requests (common in schools, possibly something like Jira Service Desk or an email-based helpdesk). Be ready to juggle requests from different sites, prioritizing as necessary.
- **Daily Operational Routines:** Internally, the school runs on well-defined schedules:
 - **Staff Devotions:** Every school day at DCS begins with a short staff prayer and devotion session. As Warren Melville (former Principal) shared, "We have staff devotions which is my favourite part of the day". This usually happens before students arrive (e.g., 8:00–8:20am). It sets a collaborative, prayerful tone for the day. As staff, you'll be part of these – it's a time for a Bible reading, a brief encouragement (often different staff lead on different days), and praying for the students and school. It's a unique internal process that reinforces the **shared Christian culture** among the team each day.

- **Morning Admin Meetings:** On certain days, there might be quick admin or department meetings following devotions. For instance, the ICT team might huddle on Monday mornings to plan major tasks for the week. The Preschool staff likely have briefings on child needs or parent messages for the day.
- **Chapel and Assemblies:** Weekly, the whole school or sub-schools gather for **Chapel** (worship and message) in the auditorium. The schedule could be something like primary on one day, secondary on another, and a combined assembly occasionally. The ICT/AV team often sets up sound, projection, etc., for these – an internal routine where you might find yourself running the PowerPoint or mixing audio for a worship band. Student-led worship teams and chapel presentations are part of the student leadership development. As support staff, participating or at least assisting technically in chapel is common.
- **Internal Communications:** The school likely has a **weekly staff bulletin** or internal newsletter. This might be emailed or posted on the Schoolbox staff portal. It contains reminders (duty rosters, upcoming events, prayer points, policy changes, etc.). Ensuring you read these communications is crucial – it's the school's way to keep everyone on the same page. Additionally, noticeboards in the staff room might have information like compliance training dates or social committee news.
- **Student Pastoral Care System:** DCS has a well-defined pastoral care and discipline system consistent with its Christian ethos. Internally, teachers use a system (possibly within Sentral or a separate pastoral module) to log merits or concerns. The emphasis is on redemptive discipline – guiding students rather than just punishing. This means if you interact with students (e.g., supervising in the library), you'll follow a gentle, restorative approach for behavior management. Serious issues are escalated to the relevant Coordinator or Deputy. All staff are briefed on child safety and the code of conduct (DCS is a registered Child Safe School). So there are processes like signing in visitors, wearing ID badges, and never being 1:1 isolated with a child – these are part of internal safeguarding procedures you'll be expected to know.

To summarize the systems: **on a given day you might use Sentral to check a student's details, Schoolbox to post a library announcement, Office 365 for emails/calendars, the library catalog to issue books, and the Digistorm app to see parent communications.** Meanwhile, behind the scenes, your ICT team is maintaining servers, networks, iPads, backups (Veeam), and planning improvements – so you get to contribute both at the user-facing level and in technical upkeep. The multi-campus structure means a bit of remote support too, but also resource pooling (e.g., DCS's high school science teacher might advise WCS's teacher – similarly, you might travel once a term to WCS to check their IT or help their library set-up). The **efficient procedures and documentation** emphasized in job descriptions indicate you'll have protocols to follow – likely there's an ICT procedures manual and a library operations manual for consistency.

How Do the Dubbo and Wellington Campuses and Preschool Work Together?

Even though DCS, WCS, and DCP operate in different locations or divisions, they function as one extended community. **Resource sharing and integration** are key internal processes:

- **Unified Vision and Policies:** Under BCE, all campuses share the same Vision (“*to equip students... to be transformational with a heart for Christ*”) and core policies. For example, the **curriculum philosophy** is aligned – Wellington CS uses many of Dubbo’s approaches. WCS’s vision and core values were realigned to match DCS when the merger happened, so WCS families “feel the Dubbo Christian School ethos too”. As staff, you’ll notice any policy (say, the Staff Code of Conduct or Assessment Policy) is issued by *Berakah* and covers all schools. This makes it easier for someone in your role to work across the board because the expectations are consistent.
- **Centralized Administration:** We touched on this in systems – **HR, Finance, ICT, and Compliance** are centralized. So, for instance, one Business Manager (Scott Morris) oversees budgets for all three, meaning **purchases and asset management are coordinated**. If the preschool needs a new photocopier or the Wellington campus needs an internet upgrade, those go through the same channels as DCS requests. This process ensures smaller branches like WCS or DCP get support they might not afford on their own. It also means **common platforms**: staff at all sites use the same email domain, access the same intranet, etc. You might get calls from a Wellington teacher that their email or Sentral isn’t working – and you’ll handle it just as you would a Dubbo issue, because it’s one system.
- **Staff Development and Interaction:** **Joint training** is a hallmark of internal cooperation. There are occasions where all staff from Dubbo, Wellington, and the Preschool come together (e.g., start-of-year staff conference, professional development days). The Board and leadership encourage this unity. In fact, when WCS was integrated in 2014, one of the benefits was combined **teacher professional development and curriculum planning** opportunities. As a result, you might find Wellington staff joining virtually (or in person) for staff meetings or training sessions hosted at Dubbo. The ICT team could be asked to ensure video conferencing is set up for such meetings. CEN (Christian Education National) conferences also gather representatives from all campuses – often the **Principal and some teachers from each campus attend together**. This fosters a “one school, multiple campuses” feeling.
- **Student Activities and Transitions:** The campuses coordinate on student experiences. For example:
 - The **Preschool is situated on the Dubbo campus grounds**, intentionally so that preschoolers can smoothly transition to “big school.” There are processes like preschool kids visiting the Kindergarten classrooms during Term 4, attending a school assembly with Year 5 “buddies,” etc. As a preschool admin, you might help organize these *transition days*. It’s a way to make DCP a feeder for DCS and to acclimate families. The preschool shares facilities

- like the playground (in a scheduled way) and can use the school's Hall for special events or the library for story sessions.
- **WCS and DCS interactions:** Though 50 km apart, there is a daily bus that runs from Wellington to Dubbo for some families. Also, they sometimes hold **joint events** – e.g., a combined sports day or having WCS students join DCS for a Year 6 camp. WCS being small, they benefit from inclusion in DCS's broader activities. The Board minutes or newsletters have indicated cross-campus activities as a priority to "extend the reach of Christian education in the region". For your role, this might mean helping set up IT for a joint Zoom assembly, or cataloguing resources that get sent over to WCS.
 - **The High School support for WCS:** Teachers at DCS sometimes coach or mentor WCS staff in specialist subjects. Similarly, the ICT and library services extend to WCS. Don't be surprised if, for example, Wellington's library (if they have a small one) is managed as a sub-collection of the DCS library system, and you might occasionally do tasks for it (like help enter new books into the database for WCS). The **culture is one of helping each other** – a bit like how a small satellite campus leans on the main campus.
 - **Communication Flow:** All major communications (from Board or Principal) cover all campuses. If the Executive Principal writes a "Principal's Welcome" in the prospectus, he references the whole Berakah group. In the Dubbo Christian Preschool prospectus, the Vision and Mission statements are identical to the school's, showing alignment. Practically, as staff, you'll receive emails addressed to "All Staff – Dubbo, Wellington, Preschool" for important announcements. Each campus might have its own staff briefings, but anything significant (like a policy update, or a new COVID guideline) is organization-wide. There's also likely a **shared calendar** for events so that, for instance, WCS's special events don't clash with DCS ones if families or leaders attend both. Indeed, one benefit of having someone like Board member Jeff Neill (a bus company manager) is that he can help coordinate transportation and logistics across sites – an example of integration: heavy vehicles were rerouted during school times to improve safety at Dubbo, and those considerations come up in Board meetings where both campuses are discussed.

In essence, the **internal mantra is "we are one school in multiple locations."** For you, this means more collaboration and variety – you won't be siloed. The preschool may be your base, but you're part of the broader Dubbo Christian School staff and will interact with primary and secondary staff regularly (the preschool itself is physically next to the primary classrooms, facilitating that closeness). The Wellington team is more distant but still connected via digital means and occasional visits. The integration has been working well for a decade now: it rescued WCS from struggling and made the whole organization stronger. As the Board President said during the 2020 reorganization, it *"was not so much a name change as the creation of a new organisation"* – bringing these schools under one banner has created a vibrant, unified Christian educational community in the region.

What Is the Culture and Work Environment Like?

Knowing the systems and hierarchy is important, but equally vital is understanding the **culture, ethos, and day-to-day atmosphere** at DCS and its related sites. By all accounts, DCS has a **warm, faith-centered, and professional culture** that will likely define your work life. Here are some key cultural and procedural aspects:

- **Christian Ethos in Practice:** DCS's motto is "*Learning in Truth*," based on John 14:6 ("I am the way, the truth, and the life"). This isn't just a slogan on the wall – it shapes how staff teach, relate, and even how admin tasks are done. The idea is that **all truth is God's truth**, so whether one is teaching a math lesson or troubleshooting a computer, we do it "*as unto the Lord*." You'll notice frequent prayer – not just in morning devotions but also in meetings, before major decisions, etc. Staff and students often pause to give thanks or seek guidance. It creates a supportive environment; for instance, if there's a difficult situation (say a family bereavement or a sick colleague), the community rallies in prayer and practical help. The leadership emphasizes "*authentic Christian foundations*" and a *"caring and service-oriented culture"*. In practical terms, this means **servant leadership** is modeled – don't be surprised if you see the Principal flipping sausages at the BBQ or the ICT Manager helping stack chairs after assembly. Everyone pitches in beyond their job description at times, which builds camaraderie. As Paul Arundell puts it, the goal is a "*loving community*" where each student and staff member is valued as being *"uniquely and lovingly made in the image of God"*. That worldview might come through even in how IT support is delivered – with patience, kindness, and a teaching mindset rather than just efficiency.
- **High Standards and Continuous Improvement:** Alongside its Christian atmosphere, DCS strives for excellence in education and operations. The **school has grown significantly** and is regarded as a top-quality school in the region (competing with other private schools like the Anglican Grammar). The administration uses data and strategic planning extensively. For example, under Mr. Arundell's leadership, they developed a new **Strategic Master Plan** for facilities through broad staff/community workshops, and even track metrics like solar panel performance as a stewardship lesson. This indicates a culture that values transparency and improvement. In staff meetings, expect discussions not just about "what to do" but "*why we do it this way*" and "*how can we do it better*." The ICT department might, for instance, regularly review helpdesk response times or downtime logs to improve service. The library might survey students on what books or services they find most helpful. The **tone is proactive and innovative**, but grounded in the school's mission. They also emphasize professional development – staff attend both Christian education conferences and secular training (via AISNSW) to stay current. You will likely have opportunities to upskill (perhaps courses on library science updates, new educational technologies, etc.). The school encourages staff to pursue excellence, evidenced by its long-term success and even the **Preschool's achievement:** Dubbo Christian Preschool has been rated "*Exceeding National Quality Standard*" consistently since 2014, which is a rare feat. Maintaining such high quality requires an ongoing reflective culture – e.g., preschool staff regularly evaluate their program against NQS criteria. You might be involved in those quality improvement meetings.

- Community and Relationships:** One internal saying is that the school is a *“thriving learning community”*. The sense of community is strong among staff, students, and families. There are likely social events for staff (staff lunches, prayer groups, Friday treats in the staff room, etc.). Parents are seen as partners – many are association members and volunteers. Don’t be surprised if parent volunteers are in the library covering new books or helping in the canteen (there’s a school canteen and a parent-run **“Harvest Café”** for coffee, indicating parent involvement on campus). Being a smaller city, Dubbo’s community feel extends into the school; people know each other well. Wellington is even smaller – the WCS staff are few, so they often join DCS for major events to feel included. For you, this means **building good relationships is key**: with teachers (who you’ll support in ICT and library needs), with students (who you might supervise or assist in research), and with parents (you could be manning the front desk phones occasionally or helping a parent IT query about the portal). The internal expectation is to be **approachable and earnest** – as said of Mr. Arundell, *“known to greet students by name and lead by example”*. All staff are encouraged to model that friendliness and personal touch.
- Facilities and Environment:** Internally, the school benefits from great facilities which make daily processes smoother. The campus has specialized buildings: e.g., a **large Multi-Purpose Hall (800-seat)** for assemblies and events, a **gymnasium** for sports (so PE classes aren’t weather-disrupted), modern science labs, etc. The **library is a significant space** on campus – likely a well-loved spot by students for study and lunch breaks. It can fit multiple classes and also hosts after-school study sessions. As staff, you’ll enjoy working in these environments. The new Primary facilities being built (as of 2025 a major project is underway for a new two-story primary block, seen in construction updates) will further enhance the work environment. The **Preschool got a new building in 2022**, so it’s a colorful, well-equipped space with child-friendly design – great for you since that’s part of your workspace. Outdoor areas are also notable: the school recently expanded ovals and playgrounds, providing ample room for activities. One unique feature is the inclusion of indigenous culture in the environment (e.g., an outdoor yarning circle with local Wiradjuri language engravings, part of the new design by Stanton Dahl Architects). The **physical setting is peaceful** – on the edge of Dubbo with open space around, creating a safe, calm atmosphere for work and learning. Safety is a priority: the school worked with the city to impose heavy truck restrictions on Sheraton Road during school hours, and has secure fencing and monitored entries for child protection. For staff, that means a secure campus where procedures (like visitor sign-in, evacuation drills, etc.) are well established.
- Traditions and Internal Events:** Over 40 years, DCS has developed rich traditions which are key internal “processes” annually. For example, **Speech Night** (annual awards evening), **Year 12 Graduation**, **School Fete** (the school held a 40th anniversary twilight fete in 2023, involving alumni and current families), and **service projects** (students fundraise or serve local causes, often organized by staff mentors). The **House system** likely means carnivals and competitions that staff help run. As library/ICT staff, you might coordinate events like **Book Week** celebrations or ICT clubs. The school also engages with broader networks – e.g., **CEN student conventions**, **Combined Christian Schools events for sport or arts**. Internally,

that means extra planning: sending a team to a convention, arranging relief staff, etc. Staff often wear multiple hats during events (you might help as an event photographer or scorekeeper once in a while!). The Wellington campus and Preschool join some of these traditions (the preschool kids might do a little item at Speech Night or a Christmas concert). All these contribute to a **family-like culture** where every achievement is celebrated community-wide.

In summary, **working at DCS (and DCP) in 2026, you'll find a collaborative, Christ-centered team environment.** Expect **mornings of prayer**, days filled with varied tasks supporting both educators and students, and an ethos that balances **grace and professionalism** – praying with a colleague about a personal challenge one moment, and in the next, rigorously troubleshooting a network issue or implementing a new library program with excellence. The public data consistently shows DCS as “*an authentic Christian learning community*” with a reputation for quality and care. Internally, that translates to a workplace where **faith, learning, and service go hand in hand.**

Recent Developments and Looking Ahead to 2026

Finally, it helps to know the **current initiatives and future plans** as you enter the school, so you can fit your work into the bigger picture:

- **Leadership Transition:** As noted, 2025 is a transition year in top leadership. Mr. Paul Arundell is finishing his principalship, and the school conducted a nationwide search for a new Principal to start in 2026. By the time you start, the new Executive Principal will be taking the helm. The *Daily Liberal* hinted that **Mr. Greg Collins (former Deputy)** would step up as the new Principal, though official confirmation will come through school channels. A **Commissioning Service** for the new Principal is likely (a special assembly with community and possibly a church leader to pray over the new head, a tradition in Christian schools). Internally, expect some **adjustments in the Senior Leadership Team** – a new principal might bring slight reorganizations or new strategic goals. However, given the strong foundation, it's expected to be a smooth transition, with ongoing emphasis on the current strategic plan until any new plan is developed collaboratively with staff and Board.
- **Campus Expansion Projects:** DCS is in the midst of facilities upgrades. The **Master Plan** (developed with Stanton Dahl Architects) is being rolled out. In late 2025, a major construction of a new classroom block (and possibly a new admin/library building) for the primary school is underway – a concrete slab was recently poured (as seen on social media updates). By 2026, these new facilities might be coming online, meaning **shifting of classrooms or offices**. You might see the library preparing to possibly move or expand if a new space is designated. Also, additional land acquisitions in 2021–2023 expanded the campus size for new playing fields, which have been completed and were being utilized for sports by 2024. So in 2026, the school has **brand-new ovals and playgrounds** – part of internal improvements that boost school spirit and capacity. Wellington CS, meanwhile, had building upgrades around 2022 and is likely stable in facilities for now. The

Preschool's building is very new (opened in 2022), so no big changes there except maybe growing enrollment to full capacity (it has three rooms for 3- and 4-year-olds programs and caters to 120 children at full capacity). Keeping track of these projects is useful as an admin – you might help with communications to parents about any relocations or tech setup in new rooms.

- **Enrollment Growth:** All schools are growing. Dubbo is a growing city and DCS has nearly 700 students (up from ~590 a couple of years prior). WCS has shown small but steady growth (e.g., 73 students in 2022, slightly up from 2021). The Preschool often has waitlists, being a sought-after preschool with an “Exceeding” rating. Growth is a blessing but also means **internal scaling of processes**: more students = more devices to manage, more library books, more admin workload. The school's strategy has been to **plan for growth** – e.g., hiring additional staff, expanding infrastructure, and maintaining excellent student-to-teacher ratios. As part of this, DCS has joined initiatives like being part of the Association of Independent Schools (AIS NSW) which helps with teacher training as enrollment grows. The Board keeps an eye on growth to ensure quality doesn't dilute. As a new staff, you'll likely see the **welcoming of new colleagues**; onboarding processes are pretty established (expect orientation sessions on child safety, IT policies, etc.). The culture is to integrate new staff quickly into the “DCS way.” The fact that DCS has remained so strong while growing “from 44 to almost 700 students over four decades” speaks to a robust internal culture that you will become a part of.
- **Academic and Co-curricular Focus:** Internally, there is a push to not only maintain academic standards but to innovate. Recent years saw improvements in literacy/numeracy via explicit instruction methods in the Primary school. The high school has been expanding subject offerings (24 HSC subjects by 2023) and tracking results. By 2026, the school might be implementing new syllabuses (NSW is rolling out updated curricula) – the Director of Teaching & Learning and team will spearhead that. You might see related PD sessions. Co-curricular programs (music, sports, arts) are thriving; the school regularly participates in inter-school competitions (through Christian Schools Sports leagues or Combined Independent Schools). For instance, DCS competes in regional sports and likely organizes some home games or carnivals. Internally, this means the sports coordinator might ask IT to ensure the PA system on the oval works or to update scores on the website. The **performing arts** department might put on an annual school musical or drama production, utilizing the Hall – expect a fun flurry of tech needs (lighting, sound, ticketing systems) during those times. As library staff, you could tie in by doing a display for the production's theme or running a related book workshop.
- **Community Engagement and Faith Activities:** The school's Christian life is dynamic – they often host events like Grandparents Day, Mother/Father's Day gatherings, and prayer evenings. They also invite local pastors or missionaries to speak at chapel. Being part of the admin team, you may help coordinate these guests (booking, IT setup). Also noteworthy: **service trips or camps** are back in action post-pandemic. Year groups (especially high school) have annual camps – e.g., Year 9 adventure camp, Year 11 leadership retreat. The Duke of Edinburgh program might be offered. A mission trip (perhaps overseas or to an indigenous

community) might be on the cards for senior students – reflecting the school's heart for service. Such activities require logistics (permission forms, fundraising, travel arrangements) that admin staff assist with. It demonstrates that the **internal workings include a ministry mindset**: it's not just a school that runs classes, but one that actively discipless students and reaches out to the community. Wellington CS, for example, interacts with local churches and community events in Wellington, extending DCS's influence regionally.

- **Digital Innovations:** By 2026, DCS may further integrate technology in learning. The presence of a Schoolbox-based app indicates the school wants to be at the forefront of parent engagement tech. They could adopt new e-learning tools (maybe expanding use of Teams or OneNote for interactive lessons, or piloting STEM programs like robotics given their new facilities). Internally, you should stay adaptable – the ICT Department might roll out new platforms (for instance, an upgrade of the library system or a new ID card system for student sign-in). One clue: the school's app partnership with Digistorm suggests a trend of **streamlining communication**. They might aim to reduce emails and use the app for announcements and maybe eventually things like digital attendance notifications or payment of fees. Embracing these will be part of your role – helping colleagues and parents get the most out of new tools.

Overall, stepping into 2026, **Dubbo Christian School is in a strong position** – spiritually grounded, growing in numbers, upgrading physically and technologically, and welcoming new leadership to carry the mission forward. The internal environment you'll join is one that has **decades of legacy but also forward momentum**. Public data paints a picture of a school that is "Bible-based and Christ-centered" yet also professionally run and constantly improving. In practical terms, you'll experience a well-run organization: clear policies, supportive colleagues, and a management that values your contribution (support staff like ICT and library are highly regarded because they enable teachers and students to excel).

By familiarizing yourself with the above aspects – governance, key personnel, systems, culture, and current initiatives – you'll be well-prepared to navigate the **internal workings of DCS, the Preschool, and WCS**. You'll know *who* to talk to for what (e.g., Board Chair for a governance query, Business Manager for resources, Preschool Director for anything early-childhood-specific), *what tools* you'll be using daily, and *how* things are typically done in this community. It's an exciting, faith-filled workplace where you can expect both professional growth and the reward of serving in a ministry capacity. As the Berakah vision states, *"in partnership, to equip students with a distinctive and responsive education, to be transformational with a heart for Christ"* – by joining the team, you become a part of that internal partnership, contributing through ICT and library services to bless the next generation. Welcome aboard!

Sources:

- Dubbo Christian School – *About Us* and official publications
- Berakah Christian Education (Association/Board information)

- DCS Staff Employment Packs (IT Systems Admin 2023, Principal 2025, Teacher Librarian)
- *Consult Clarity* interview with Warren Melville (former Principal)
- Dubbo Christian Preschool – Prospectus and public info
- Wellington Christian School – Annual Report 2022
- Dubbo Christian School – Deep Research Expansion Report (2025)
- Architecture AU – Stanton Dahl masterplan overview